

NICK CLAYTON

Active TS/SCI Clearance

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technology and operational modernization leader with over eight years of experience deploying AI-enabled analytical systems, enterprise data workflows, and mission-support capabilities across defense, interagency, and multinational environments. Proven record leading cross-functional teams, operationalizing AI/ML workflows, and scaling enterprise analytical capabilities supporting organizations of more than 70,000 personnel. Combines technical program management, operational leadership, and hands-on experience with Python, Docker, Linux/WSL, Git-based workflows, and data integration systems to deliver scalable solutions in complex mission environments.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Technical Program Management & Leadership

Technical Program Management | Cross-Functional Leadership | Organizational Transformation | Stakeholder Engagement | Agile/Scrum

Software, Infrastructure & Development

Python | pandas | scikit-learn | Elasticsearch | Docker | Git | GitHub | Linux/WSL | Next.js | Vercel | SaaS Deployment | JIRA | Confluence

AI, Data & Analytical Systems

AI/ML Operationalization | Predictive Analytics | Data Fusion | Activity-Based Analysis | Entity Resolution | Link Analysis | Analytical Automation | Geospatial Analytics | ISR Synchronization | Intelligence Modernization

Operational Platforms & Analysis

Palantir Maven MSS | FADE | Thresher | Vannevar Decrypt | Dataminr First Alert | Seerist | JEMA | ArcGIS | CHROME | Collection Management | OSINT Analysis | Interagency Coordination | Multinational Operations

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

UNITED STATES NAVY | Various Locations | 2018 – Present

Director of Intelligence Integration & Technical Programs | Coronado, CA | 2022 – Present

Naval Special Warfare (NSW) — Special Reconnaissance Team ONE

- Engineered enterprise-scale cross-domain analytics pipelines processing approximately 850,000 global commercial and public data sources in near real time, transforming fragmented manual workflows into scalable operational data-integration capabilities.
- Directed integration and deployment strategy for enterprise SaaS analytical platforms across a 70,000-person organization, aligning USSOCOM leadership, vendors, contracting teams, engineers, and operational end users under a \$280M modernization initiative at no additional program cost.
- Operationalized AI/ML-enabled analytical capabilities and predictive analytics workflows leveraging clustering models and activity-based analysis to improve operational awareness and support identification of 75 high-priority entities during multinational operations.
- Accelerated transition of emerging RDT&E technologies from prototype development into operational field deployment, contributing to adoption across 20 global mission environments over four years.
- Developed secure automated analytics workflows integrating commercial, public, and sensitive data streams to enhance indications-and-warning analysis, improve target discovery, and expand enterprise network-analysis capabilities.
- Built and scaled a mission-focused operational capability from a five-person pilot team into a 50-person deployable organization, establishing a framework influencing broader restructuring efforts across a 500-person command.
- Led cross-agency collection-management initiatives spanning 15 working groups across 13 organizations, enabling automated intelligence workflows, supporting 22 ISR operations, and informing 90 operational and strategic decision-support products.

Intelligence Operations Manager | Whidbey Island, WA | **2018 – 2022**

Electronic Attack Squadron ONE THREE ONE (VAQ-131)

- Directed development of enterprise modernization and evaluation frameworks for emerging smart communications systems, authoring testing protocols, POAMs, and operational validation strategies adopted to inform future electronic warfare capability development.
- Led multi-domain intelligence operations during large-scale coalition exercises involving U.S., UK, and Australian forces across contested electromagnetic environments, supporting complex air operations with more than 90 aircraft and contributing to advanced tactical qualification and certification outcomes for three senior mission leaders and 12 Weapons and Tactics Instructors.
- Achieved distinction as the only enlisted graduate of the Electronic Attack Weapons School in 2019 after independently developing specialized expertise in electromagnetic warfare, integrated air defense systems, and operational mission planning.
- Directed end-to-end migration and governance efforts for 276 personnel security records during the DoD JPAS-to-DISS transition, implementing validation and audit controls that achieved zero-loss conversion results unmatched across 14 peer units.

SELECTED TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Entity Discovery Engine

Python | scikit-learn | pandas | Docker | GitHub | Linux/WSL | **April 2026 – Present**

- Engineered a containerized analytical pipeline supporting spatiotemporal entity correlation and automated relationship discovery across structured maritime datasets.
- Developed machine learning-enabled workflows using Python, pandas, and scikit-learn to support event detection, clustering, and analytical scoring methodologies.
- Built explainable scoring frameworks and human-in-the-loop analytical workflows to improve interpretability and operational decision support.
- Implemented Docker-based containerization, Git-driven version control, and modular project architecture to support scalable deployment and future orchestration expansion.

Technical Portfolio & Project Infrastructure

Next.js | Tailwind | GitHub | Vercel | GSAP | **April 2026 – Present**

- Built and deployed a technical portfolio platform showcasing AI, analytics, operational modernization, and technical leadership initiatives using modern web-development and cloud-hosting workflows.
- Developed recruiter-facing technical case studies and integrated GitHub project infrastructure translating operational experience into civilian technology and modernization outcomes.

FORMAL EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Strategic Studies & Defense Analysis

Norwich University | Northfield, VT | **March 2026**

- **Honors:** Summa Cum Laude | GPA: 3.80

Relevant Academic Focus: AI & Robotics Investment Strategy | Strategic Competition | U.S.–China Deterrence Policy | Critical Mineral Supply Chains | Defense Modernization

EXECUTIVE EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania, Wharton Executive Education | Chief Technology Officer Program | *Expected 2026*

Northwestern University, Kellogg School of Management | Advanced Analytics & Artificial Intelligence | *2024*

Cornell University, Duffield College of Engineering | Python 360 Certificate | *Expected 2026*

Cornell University, Duffield College of Engineering | Project Management Certificate | *2023*

The Honor Foundation Fellow, Cohort 134 | *2026*

PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS

Intelligence Fundamentals Professional Certification (IFPC)

GEOINT Professional Certification – Fundamentals (GPC-F)

GEOINT Professional Certification – Imagery Analysis (GPC-IA)